6.5 Uploading files

For the most part, you will use forms to capture data from the user as simple strings, although on the server, they might be converted to numeric, `DateTime`, or Boolean values. Forms can also be used to send binary data to the server, which enables the uploading of files. To combine model binding with successful file uploading, you have to meet three basic requirements:

1. The form must use the `POST` method.
2. The form must have an `enctype` attribute set to `multipart/form-data`.
3. The uploaded file must map to an instance of the `IFormFile` type or a collection of them, if you want to enable multiple file uploading.

The `IFormFile` interface lives in the `Microsoft.AspNetCore.Http` namespace and represents a file sent over HTTP. As well as some properties that provide access to information about the file—its `FileName`, `Length`, `ContentType`, and so on—the `IFormFile` interface specifies a couple of methods for copying the content to a `Stream`, so you can save it.

In a Razor Pages application, you can save the file locally to a database in binary form, or you can save it to the file system. Religious wars have broken out in the past over which approach is better! You can find remnants of these historical battlegrounds all over the internet with a bit of searching. The hills on which the battles tended to rage were related to the cost of storage and processing. With both being relatively cheap these days, the decision about storage location is now more likely to be based on